

RE04

Services, Tourism and IT in Rajasthan

About 3-4 questions a paper. Tourism and the e-governance portals are near-certain; UNESCO sites and Jan Aadhaar are repeat favourites.

Services are almost half of Rajasthan's economy, and tourism is the part of it the exam cares about most. Add the state's e-governance portals - Jan Aadhaar, e-Mitra, SSO - and you have a chapter where almost every question is a name, a year or a place.

Services, Tourism and IT

Services share

- 47.7% of GSVA - largest sector
- Trade, transport, tourism, banking
- Industry 26.5%, agriculture 25.7%

Arrivals 2024

- Domestic about 23 crore
- Foreign about 20.7 lakh
- 5th among states in both

Banking

- SLBC convenor - Bank of Baroda
- RBI regional office - Jaipur
- Rajasthan Gramin Bank, 1 May 2025
- One State-One RRB

Circuits and heritage

- Desert, Shekhawati, Mewar
- Hadoti, Dhundhar, Braj-Mewar
- Four UNESCO properties
- Hill Forts - six forts, 2013

Tourism basics

- Industry status - 1989
- RTDC - 1 April 1979
- Palace on Wheels - 1982
- Royal Rajasthan on Wheels - 2009
- RITMAN - 1996

IT and e-governance

- IT and ITes Policy 2015, DoIT&C
- RISL - implementing arm
- Jan Aadhaar 2019, ten digits
- e-Mitra, SSO, Raj Kaj, Sampark
- iStart, Bhamashah Techno Hub

The services sector - almost half the state economy

Services means everything that is neither farming nor manufacturing - shops and trade, transport, hotels and tourism, banking and insurance, real estate, and government itself. In Rajasthan it is the largest of the three sectors and the fastest growing. That single ranking is the most asked fact here.

Rajasthan's GSDP by sector (Rajasthan Economic Review 2025-26)

Sector	Share	Position
Services (tertiary)	About 47.7%	Largest
Industry (secondary)	About 26.5%	Second
Agriculture and allied (primary)	About 25.7%	Third, and close behind industry

- Trade, hotels and restaurants, transport and communication form the bulk of the services block.
- Tourism is not a separate line in the accounts - it shows up inside trade, hotels, transport and personal services.
- Services also carry the state's employment growth outside agriculture.
- Rajasthan's services share is still a little below the all-India services share.

YAAD RAKHO

Remember the ladder: services close to half, industry about a quarter, agriculture about a quarter. Nearly 48 - 26 - 26. If an option puts agriculture first, reject it.

Banking and financial spread

Banking questions in RAS are institutional, not analytical. Who convenes, who is headquartered where, what merged into what. Learn those and move on.

- Bank of Baroda is the convenor bank of the State Level Bankers' Committee (SLBC) for Rajasthan.
- The Reserve Bank of India has a regional office at Jaipur.
- The SLBC coordinates the annual credit plan, priority-sector lending and the credit-deposit ratio review for the state.
- Rajasthan's credit-deposit ratio has historically run below the national average, with wide district-to-district variation.
- Insurance penetration in the state is likewise below the national level - a rural-spread problem, not an urban one.

CURRENT LINK

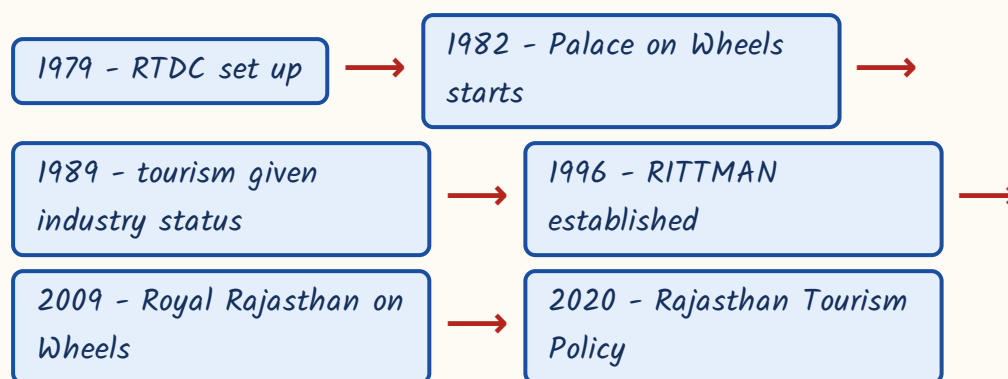
Current link (as of September 2026): under the 'One State-One RRB' policy, Rajasthan's regional rural banks were amalgamated with effect from 1 May 2025 into a single Rajasthan Gramin Bank, headquartered at Jaipur. The date and the name are both examinable.

Tourism - why Rajasthan treats it as an industry

Rajasthan sells something no other state has in the same quantity - forts, palaces, desert and living crafts. Tourism here is not a side business. It feeds hotels, transport, guides, handicrafts and fairs, and it is one of the state's biggest employment generators outside agriculture. That is why Rajasthan gave tourism the status of an industry as early as 1989, which lets tourism units claim industrial rates and benefits.

- Tourism was granted the status of an industry in Rajasthan in 1989.
- RTDC - Rajasthan Tourism Development Corporation - was set up on 1 April 1979 for accommodation, catering and transport.
- Palace on Wheels, the luxury tourist train, started in 1982 - run jointly by Indian Railways and RTDC.
- Royal Rajasthan on Wheels was introduced in 2009.
- RITTMAN - Rajasthan Institute of Tourism and Travel Management, Jaipur, established 1996 for training.

The institutional timeline of Rajasthan tourism



Who does what in tourism

Body	Role
Department of Tourism	Policy, promotion, fairs and festivals calendar
RTDC	Hotels, transport, catering, tourist units
RITTMAN	Training in tourism and travel management
Tourist Assistance Force	Safety and assistance for tourists

- RTDC runs hotels, transport and catering - it does NOT promote industrial investment.
- Industrial investment promotion belongs to the Bureau of Investment Promotion, not RTDC.
- A 'RTDC - promotion of industrial investment' pair in a matching question is always wrong.
- The Tourist Assistance Force came out of the 2020 policy, not out of RTDC.

Arrivals and Rajasthan's national rank

Two numbers matter - domestic visits and foreign visits - and one ranking. Do not confuse the scales. Domestic arrivals are counted in crores, foreign arrivals in lakhs. That difference of scale is itself an option trap.

Tourist arrivals in Rajasthan, calendar year 2024

Category	Number	Rank among states
Domestic tourist visits	About 2,300.84 lakh - roughly 23 crore	5th
Foreign tourist visits	About 20.72 lakh	5th

- Both domestic and foreign arrivals grew in double digits over 2023.
- Rajasthan is consistently among India's top five states in tourist visits.
- Uttar Pradesh leads in domestic visits; Maharashtra leads in foreign visits.
- Foreign tourists are drawn disproportionately to Jaipur, Udaipur, Jodhpur, Jaisalmer and Pushkar.

CURRENT LINK

Current link (as of September 2026): on the 2024 data compiled by the Ministry of Tourism, Rajasthan ranked fifth among Indian states in both domestic and foreign tourist visits. Ranks shift by a place or two year to year - carry the number and the year together, never the rank alone.

Tourism circuits - the matching question

A circuit is a set of neighbouring districts marketed as one itinerary. Learn each circuit by its lead district, then add the rest. The exam asks circuit-to-district matching and 'which pair is NOT correct'.

Tourist circuits of Rajasthan

Circuit	Districts covered
Desert circuit	Jaisalmer - Barmer - Bikaner - Jodhpur
Shekhawati circuit	Sikar - Jhunjhunu - Churu
Mewar circuit	Udaipur - Chittorgarh - Rajsamand
Hadoti circuit	Kota - Bundi - Jhalawar - Baran
Dhundhar / Golden Triangle	Jaipur
Braj-Mewat circuit	Bharatpur - Deeg - Alwar

Tourist circuits and their lead districts



Mewar is the south; Mewat is the east, around Alwar and Bharatpur. Never swap them.

YAAD RAKHO

Circuit names are region names. Mewar is the south (Udaipur side), Marwar-desert is the west, Hadoti is the south-east, Shekhawati is the north-east havelis, Braj-Mewat is the east near the UP border, Dhundhar is Jaipur.

TRAP

Bharatpur belongs to the Braj-Mewat circuit, NOT to Mewar. Mewar and Mewat sound alike and RPSC uses that. Mewar = Udaipur region; Mewat = Alwar-Bharatpur region.

The four UNESCO World Heritage properties

Rajasthan has four inscriptions on the UNESCO World Heritage List. Learn them with their years, because chronological ordering questions are asked from exactly this set. And learn the six Hill Forts by name - the standard question is which fort is NOT among them.

UNESCO World Heritage properties in Rajasthan

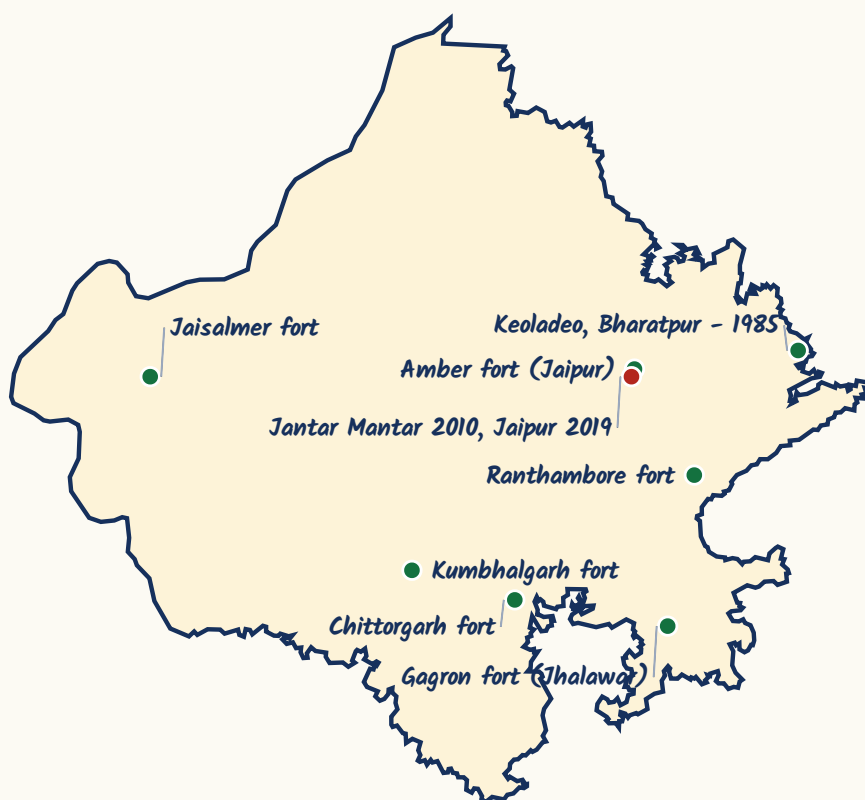
Property	District	Year of inscription
Keoladeo National Park	Bharatpur	1985
Jantar Mantar	Jaipur	2010
Hill Forts of Rajasthan (serial, six forts)	Several	2013
Jaipur City	Jaipur	2019

Order of inscription - asked as a sequencing question



- The six Hill Forts: Chittorgarh, Kumbhalgarh, Ranthambore (Sawai Madhopur), Amber (Jaipur), Jaisalmer and Gagron (Jhalawar).
- Jaipur, inscribed in 2019, is the second Indian city after Ahmedabad to be a UNESCO World Heritage City.
- Keoladeo is also a Ramsar site - it carries two international tags at once.
- These four properties are a large part of why Rajasthan draws so many foreign tourists.

World Heritage properties and the six Hill Forts



Four properties in all; the 2013 inscription is the serial group of six hill forts.

ASKED IN RAS

The standard question, asked repeatedly in state exams: which fort is NOT included in the 'Hill Forts of Rajasthan'? Answer: Mehrangarh, Jodhpur. It is a famous fort but it is not part of the 2013 inscription.

TRAP

Do not add Mehrangarh or the Sun Temple at Jhalrapatan to the UNESCO list. The count is four properties, and only four.

Tourism policy, heritage hotels and central schemes

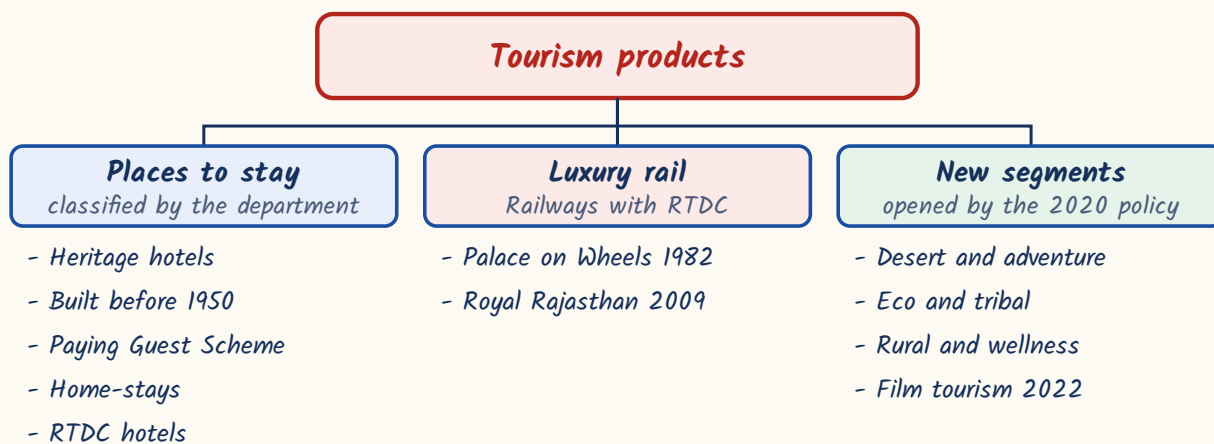
The Rajasthan Tourism Policy, 2020 was approved in September 2020 for five years. Its logic was to widen tourism beyond forts - into desert, adventure, eco, tribal, rural and wellness tourism - and to make private investment easier through special tourism zones.

- Rajasthan Tourism Policy 2020 - special tourism zones for concentrated tourism investment.
- It created a Tourist Assistance Force for tourist safety.
- It promoted home-stays and guest houses, and set up a Policy Implementation Unit.
- Film Tourism Promotion Policy, 2022 - subsidy and single-window facilitation for films shot in Rajasthan.
- A Rural Tourism Scheme was announced to develop village tourism units.

Heritage Hotel vs Paying Guest Scheme - two different ideas

Heritage Hotel	Paying Guest Scheme
A fort, palace, castle or haveli converted into a hotel	An ordinary private household registered to host tourists
The building must have been built before 1950	No age condition on the building
A classification category for tourist accommodation	A registration scheme run by the Tourism Department
Aimed at high-value heritage tourism	Aimed at cheap, home-style stay and local income

What Rajasthan sells to the tourist



Two central schemes bring money into Rajasthan's tourism sites. Both were launched by the Ministry of Tourism in 2014-15. Swadesh Darshan develops theme-based tourist circuits. PRASHAD develops pilgrimage sites.

- Swadesh Darshan - theme-based tourist circuits, Ministry of Tourism, launched 2014-15.
- PRASHAD - Pilgrimage Rejuvenation and Spiritual Augmentation Drive - the 'P' stands for Pilgrimage.
- Ajmer-Pushkar is a PRASHAD site in Rajasthan.
- Both are central sector schemes - the state executes, the Centre funds.

CURRENT LINK

Current link (as of September 2026): the Tourism Department has issued a further Rajasthan Tourism Policy / tourism unit incentive framework carrying the year 2025, which links registered tourism units to RIPS-2024 benefits, stamp duty relief and industrial power tariffs. The 2020 policy is still the one named in standard sources - carry both years and check the latest departmental notification before the exam.

IT and ITeS – policy, agencies and parks

Rajasthan's IT story is less about big software exports and more about e-governance – the state building its own digital plumbing. Two names run everything: DoIT&C is the department that makes policy, and RISL is the company that builds and runs the systems.

- Rajasthan's E-Governance, IT and ITeS Policy was announced in 2015.
- Nodal department: Department of Information Technology and Communication (DoIT&C).
- Implementing arm: RajCOMP Info Services Limited (RISL).
- iStart Rajasthan, run by DoIT&C, is the state's startup platform; QRate is its evaluation and rating mechanism.
- Bhamashah Techno Hub, Jaipur is one of the country's large startup incubation facilities.

Where IT activity is concentrated

City	Location / hub
Jaipur	Sitapura, Mahindra World City SEZ, Jhalana
Jodhpur	Boranada
Udaipur	Expanding IT facilities

- BharatNet, RajNET and the Rajasthan State Wide Area Network form the state's connectivity backbone.
- RajDhara is the state's geospatial and GIS platform.
- BPO promotion and IT park development are handled with RIICO land support.

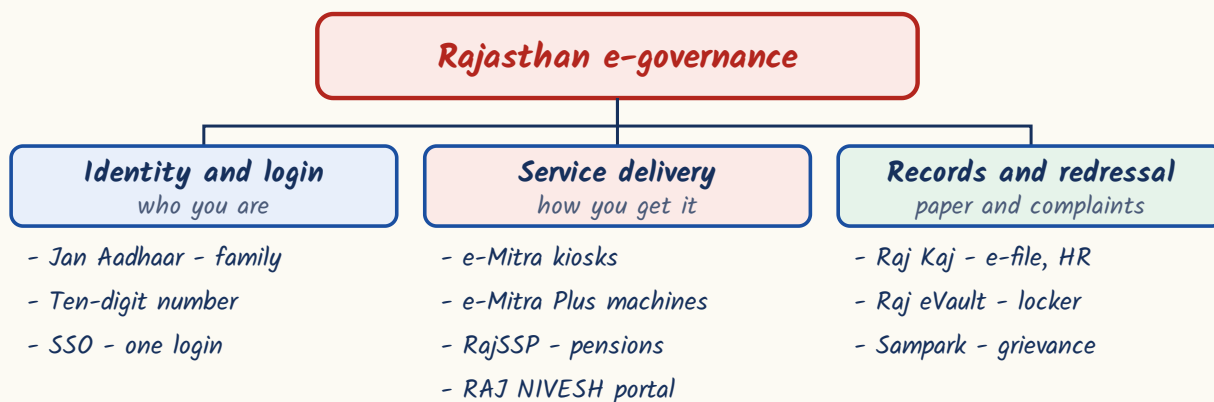
The e-governance stack - portal to purpose, the exam's favourite matching set

Learn these as a stack. One identity for the family (Jan Aadhaar), one login for services (SSO), one counter to deliver them (e-Mitra), one system for files inside government (Raj Kaj), one channel for complaints (Rajasthan Sampark), one locker for documents (Raj eVault). If you can say each portal's job in four words, you will not lose a matching question.

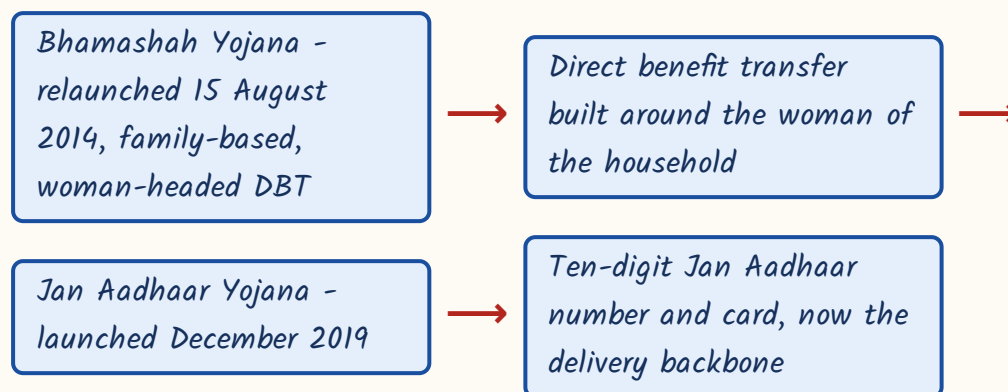
Portal to purpose

Portal / platform	Purpose
Jan Aadhaar	Family identity and benefit delivery - one number, one card, one identity
e-Mitra	Single-point kiosk delivery of government services and utility payments
SSO Rajasthan (Single Sign On)	One login identity across state government portals
Raj Kaj	e-file and human resource management inside government offices
Rajasthan Sampark	Public grievance registration and redressal, helpline 181
Raj eVault	Secure digital storage and sharing of citizens' documents
RAJ NIVESH	Single window clearance for investors
Raj Udyog Mitra	Acknowledgement certificate for new MSMEs
RajDhara	State geospatial and GIS platform
RajSSP	Social security pension disbursement and tracking

The e-governance stack, grouped by job



How the family-identity scheme evolved



- Jan Aadhaar was launched in December 2019 and gives every family a TEN-digit number.
- Its slogan is 'one number, one card, one identity'.
- It replaced Bhamashah as the backbone for delivering state benefits.
- e-Mitra Plus machines extend e-Mitra into self-service kiosks.

ASKED IN RAS

RAS Pre 2021 asked the number of digits in the Jan Aadhaar number.

Answer: ten. RAS Pre 2018 and 2024 both used portal-to-purpose matching from exactly the table above.

ASKED IN RAS

RAS Pre 2016 asked which was India's first state to be declared a 'Digital State'. Answer: KERALA, in 2016 - not Rajasthan. RPSC liked it so much it asked the same fact twice in that one paper.

TRAP

Rajasthan is strong on e-governance, so candidates instinctively answer 'Rajasthan' to any digital-first question. First digital state = Kerala. Second UNESCO World Heritage City after Ahmedabad = Jaipur. Keep the two 'firsts' straight.

ASKED IN RAS

A 2024-style statement set: Rajasthan Sampark is the grievance portal, Raj Kaj is the government e-file and HR system, Raj eVault is the document locker. All three statements are correct. The wrong option in such sets is usually 'Raj eVault - payment of electricity bills'.

REVISION RECAP

1. Services about 47.7% of GSVA - the largest sector; industry 26.5%, agriculture 25.7%.
2. Bank of Baroda convenes the SLBC for Rajasthan; RBI has a regional office at Jaipur.
3. One State-One RRB: Rajasthan Gramin Bank formed 1 May 2025, headquartered at Jaipur.
4. Tourism got industry status in Rajasthan in 1989.
5. RTDC set up 1 April 1979; Palace on Wheels 1982; Royal Rajasthan on Wheels 2009; RITTMAN 1996.
6. 2024 arrivals: domestic about 23 crore, foreign about 20.72 lakh - Rajasthan 5th on both.
7. Circuits: Desert, Shekhawati, Mewar, Hadoti, Dhundhar, Braj-Mewat.
8. Bharatpur is Braj-Mewat, not Mewar. Mewar means Udaipur-Chittorgarh-Rajsamand.
9. Four UNESCO properties: Keoladeo 1985, Jantar Mantar 2010, Hill Forts 2013, Jaipur City 2019.

10. Six Hill Forts: Chittorgarh, Kumbhalgarh, Ranthambore, Amber, Jaisalmer, Gagron. Mehrangarh excluded.
11. Jaipur is India's second World Heritage City, after Ahmedabad.
12. Tourism Policy 2020 - special tourism zones, Tourist Assistance Force, home-stays, wider tourism forms.
13. Heritage Hotel = pre-1950 fort, palace, castle or haveli converted; Paying Guest = registered private household.
14. Swadesh Darshan (circuits) and PRASHAD (pilgrimage) - Ministry of Tourism, 2014-15; Ajmer-Pushkar under PRASHAD.
15. Film Tourism Promotion Policy 2022; Rural Tourism Scheme for village tourism units.
16. E-Governance, IT and ITeS Policy 2015; DoIT&C is nodal, RISL is the implementing company.
17. Jan Aadhaar - December 2019, ten digits, replaced Bhamashah (relaunched 15 August 2014).
18. e-Mitra delivers, SSO logs in, Raj Kaj runs government files, Sampark takes grievances (181), Raj eVault stores documents.
19. iStart is the startup platform with QRate; Bhamashah Techno Hub, Jaipur is the big incubator.
20. Kerala, not Rajasthan, was India's first declared Digital State (2016).